Sarah Chen

Senior Software Engineer

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SUMMARY

Senior software engineer with 6 years of backend experience in Python and Go, including 3 years shipping LLM features to production. Designs retrieval pipelines and the offline evaluations that gate prompt and model changes.

EXPERIENCE

FERNWAY PAYMENTS | Senior Software Engineer — San Francisco, CA | Jul 2024 - Present

- Shipped a RAG support assistant (Python, FastAPI, pgvector) that resolves 38% of merchant tickets without handoff.
- Built an evaluation suite of 1,200 labeled conversations with LLM-as-judge and exact-match scorers; the team runs it in CI before merging prompt or model changes.
- Cut LLM spend by 46% by routing ticket classification to a fine-tuned 8B model and caching repeat queries in Redis.
- Rewrote the payout scheduling service in Go, raising throughput from 3k to 11k requests per second at a p99 latency under 120 ms.
- Led design reviews for a team of 6 and mentored 2 engineers through promotion to Software Engineer II.

KESTREL HEALTH | Software Engineer II — Seattle, WA | Apr 2022 - Jun 2024

- Built a clinical note summarizer on Azure OpenAI with PHI redaction, used by 1,400 clinicians across 60 clinics.
- Developed the patient scheduling API in TypeScript and Node.js for 1.2M monthly users, and added contract tests that cut production incidents by 40% year over year.
- Implemented HIPAA audit logging and role-based access control across 12 internal services.

BLUEPINE ANALYTICS | Software Engineer — Seattle, WA | Jun 2020 - Mar 2022

- Built Kafka ingestion workers in Python that process 500 GB of device telemetry per day for customer dashboards.
- Trained an Isolation Forest model in scikit-learn that flags sensor faults for 200 enterprise customers.

EDUCATION

B.S. Computer Science — 2016 - 2020

University of Washington

PROJECTS

PROMPTDIFF — Creator and Maintainer | 2024 - Present

- Open-source Python CLI that runs a prompt test suite against two model versions and reports per-case regressions; 1.1k GitHub stars.

SKILLS & AWARDS

Technical Skills: Python, Go, TypeScript, FastAPI, LLM Applications, RAG, LLM Evaluation, Fine-tuning (LoRA), PyTorch, pgvector, PostgreSQL, Redis, Kafka, AWS, Kubernetes, Terraform
Languages: English (Native), Mandarin (Professional)
Certifications: AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate